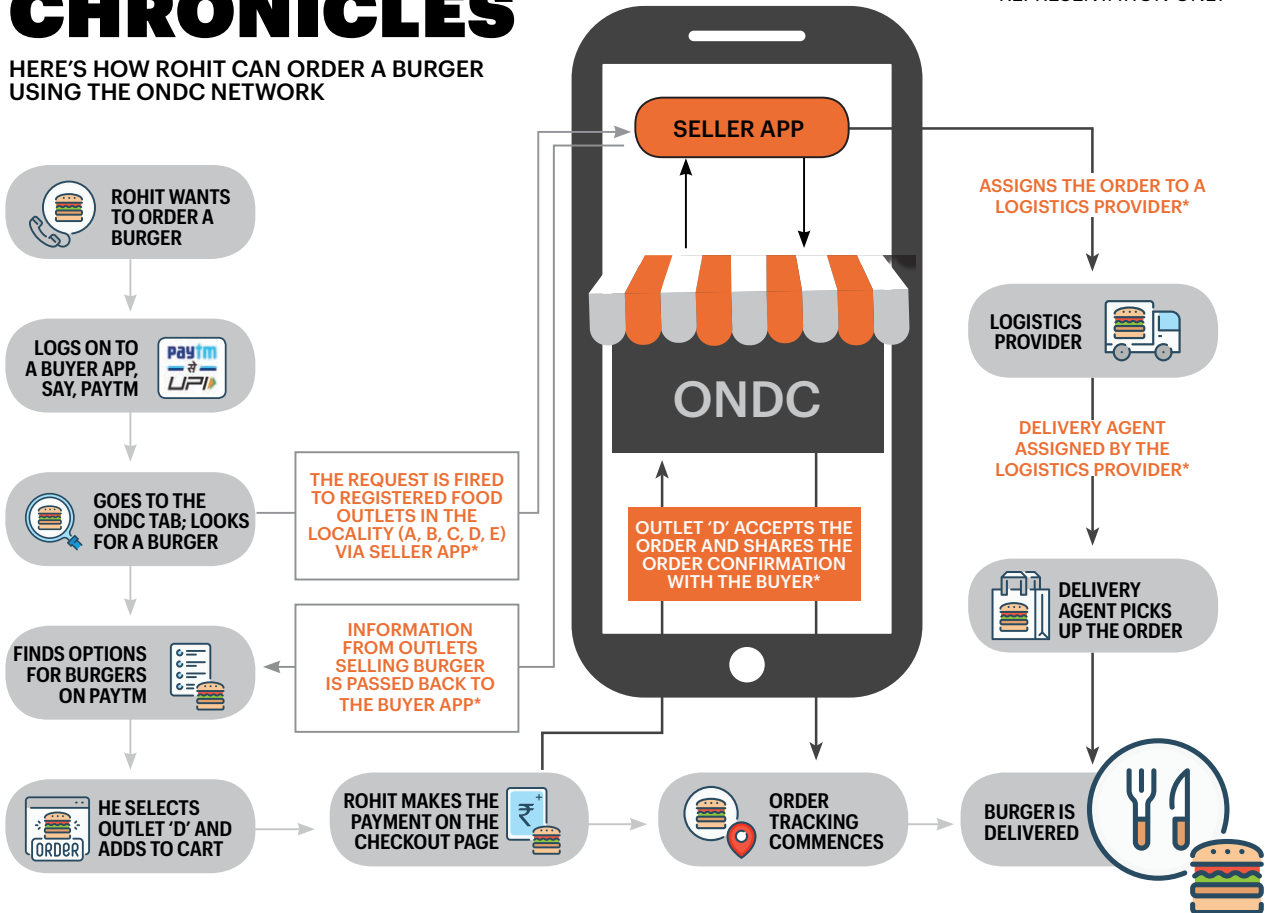


THE BURGER CHRONICLES

HERE'S HOW ROHIT CAN ORDER A BURGER USING THE ONDC NETWORK

*HAPPENS REAL-TIME ON THE BACK END VIA APIs AND IS NOT VISIBLE TO CONSUMERS; FOR REPRESENTATION ONLY



connecting small businesses directly with buyers. As early adopters, we have seen very encouraging traction.”

While Paytm’s ONDC interface has its fair share of challenges, there are bigger fish to fry when it comes to fixing buyer platforms. For instance, buyer applications need to woo their existing customers for services they’re not typically known for. And that takes some serious marketing mojo. Take Meesho, which is pretty much the go-to for small-value fashion products in smaller towns. But when it comes to food and groceries, which is what ONDC launched with, the adoption hasn’t quite taken off yet. According to the company, this might slow down the scaling-up process. “We have observed that there is a natural affinity for fashion brands and products rather than F&B in Tier II cities and beyond, which typically form a significant portion of Meesho’s user base,” says Sanjeev Barnwal, Founder and CTO at Meesho. “Unlike metro cities, the adoption of online grocery shopping is yet to pick up pace in Tier II and smaller towns.”

Amar Shankar, Partner for Government and Public Sector Consulting at EY India, says consumer campaigns are necessary to promote the network’s value

proposition. “Each buyer app has its own go-to-market strategy. However, consumers need to be aware of the ONDC value proposition as well—more choice, the ability to transact with nearby favourite mom-and-pop stores, and having single-point access to the seller universe across the country,” he says.

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THESE TEETHING CHALLENGES do not take away from the promise of ONDC. The entry of Meesho saw merchants reporting an increase in order volumes. With 80 per cent of its 140 million annually transacting customers coming from Tier II+ cities, the SoftBank-backed company has a strong use case to be on the network.

However, the real game-changer is expected to be PhonePe’s arrival, which industry experts say will pro-